

Classical Mechanics - Home Assignment 5

Hamilton-Jacobi Equation and Action-angle Variable (November 2024)

1. For planetary orbits in three dimensions, the Hamiltonian is given by

$$h = \frac{1}{2m} \left[p_r^2 + \frac{1}{r^2} p_\theta^2 + \frac{1}{r^2 \sin^2 \theta} p_\phi^2 \right] - \frac{k}{r}$$

Find Hamilton's principal function in terms of integrals over r and θ .

2. A particle slides down a cycloidal track

$$x = l(2\phi + \sin 2\phi), \quad y = l(1 - \cos 2\phi)$$

in a vertical plane without friction under gravity. Using action-angle variables, find the frequency of oscillation for $\phi \leq \pi/4$.

3. A particle of charge q is moving in a circle in X-Y plane due to a magnetic field $\vec{B}$ along Z axis. Find the adiabatic invariant when the field varies adiabatically along Z.
4. For a pendulum whose amplitude is not necessarily small, derive the action integral and hence the time period. (The result will be in the form of an integral.)